

49 Describing a process

When the thing receiving the action is more important than the person or thing doing the action, you can emphasize it using the present simple passive.

⚙️ **New language** Present simple passive

Aa **Vocabulary** Science experiments

🧩 **New skill** Describing a process

49.1 KEY LANGUAGE THE PRESENT SIMPLE PASSIVE

When it is unimportant, or not known, who or what does an action, English uses the present simple passive. The passive also has the effect of emphasizing the action.



In the experiment, water **is heated** until it boils.

It is not known or not important who heats the water.



49.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES THE PRESENT SIMPLE PASSIVE

The water **is not stirred** in this experiment.

Use "not" to form negatives of the present simple passive.



A thermometer **is suspended** above the water.



After two minutes, the temperature **is taken**.



The results **are recorded** on the chart.



49.3 HOW TO FORM THE PRESENT SIMPLE PASSIVE

SUBJECT

Water

"IS / ARE"

is

PAST PARTICIPLE

heated

REST OF SENTENCE

until it boils.

The thing that receives the action.

Present simple of verb "to be."

The past participle describes what happens to the subject.